Company overview: Patagonia

Patagonia is an American clothing company that markets and sells outdoor clothing. Founded in 1973 by Yvon Chouinard, the company is headquartered in Ventura, California. While it began as a small business making tools for climbers, it has grown into a global brand recognized for its high-quality products and, more importantly, its radical commitment to environmental and social responsibility.

What sets Patagonia apart is its unique business philosophy. Unlike traditional corporations that prioritize short-term profits for shareholders, Patagonia views business as a tool to save the home planet. In 2022, the company made headlines when the Chouinard family transferred 100% of the company's voting stock to the Patagonia Purpose Trust and all non-voting stock to the Holdfast Collective. This means that every dollar of profit not reinvested back into the business is distributed as a dividend to protect nature and fight the climate crisis. Patagonia is a certified B Corporation, proving that a company can be both financially successful and ethically grounded.

ESG

The "Worn Wear" Program

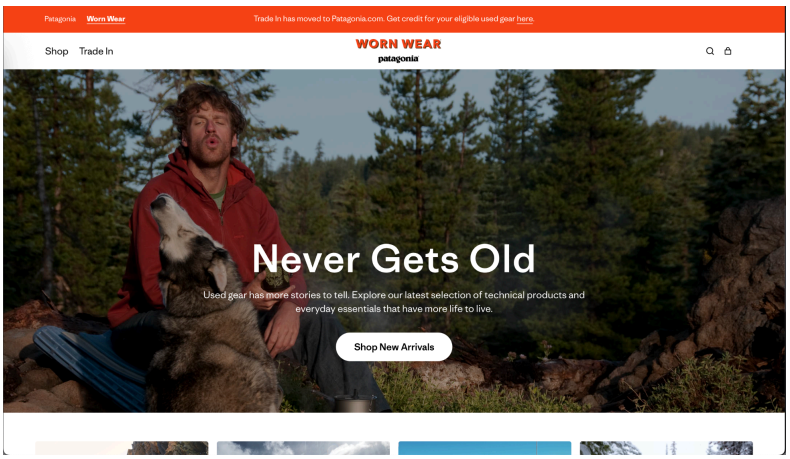
Why, How, and What

- Patagonia believes that the best way to help the planet is to make products last a long time. They realized that buying too many new things creates a lot of waste and pollution. To fix this, they started the "Worn Wear" program. They opened large repair centers and even sent out trucks to fix people's clothes for free. They also created a website where customers can trade in their old Patagonia gear for credit. This gear is cleaned, fixed, and sold again to new owners. As a result, Patagonia repairs over 40,000 items every year. This saves water and energy because people don't have to buy new clothes as often. It also makes customers trust the brand because they know the products are built to last.

Application for SMEs

- Small companies can learn to focus on quality instead of quantity. You do not need a big repair center to start. A small business can offer a simple repair service or give customers a "how-to" guide on taking care of their products. By helping your customers keep what they buy for a long time, you build a very loyal community. Being honest about how to make things last makes your brand stand out from competitors who only want to sell more.

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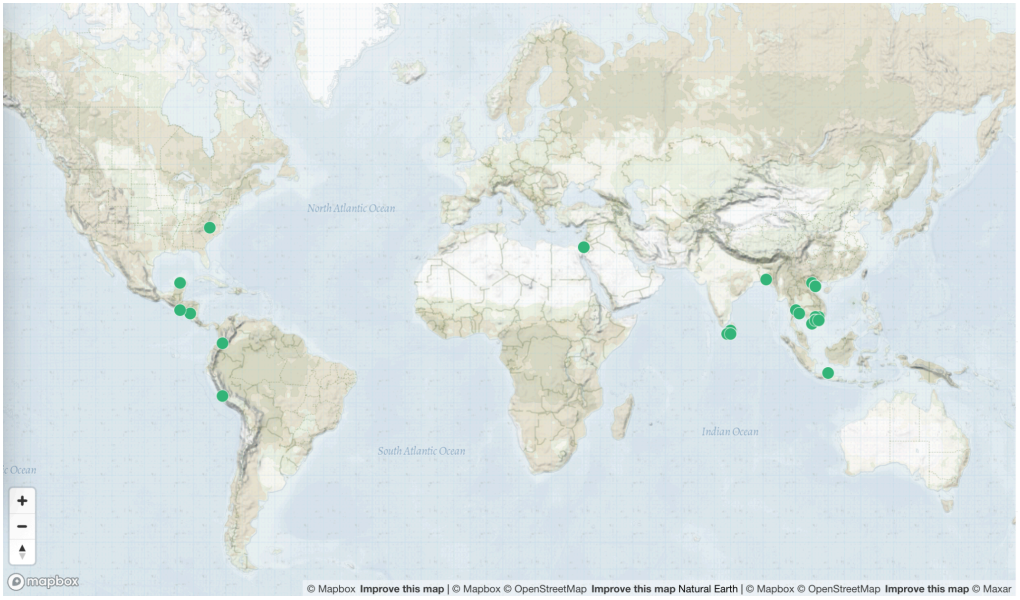


Fair trade

Why, How, and What

- Patagonia wants to make sure that the people who make their clothes are treated fairly and paid well. They also want to protect the land where their materials, like cotton, come from. To do this, they joined the Fair Trade program. For every item made in a Fair Trade factory, Patagonia pays extra money that goes directly to the workers. They also started using "Regenerative" farming, which is a way of farming that actually makes the soil healthier. They even put a map on their website so anyone can see exactly which factories they use. Today, almost all of their products are made in Fair Trade factories, helping over 85,000 workers. This makes their supply chain stronger because happy workers do better work and stay with the company longer.

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Application for SMEs

- Small businesses might think they are too small to change the world, but they can start by picking the right partners. Instead of always looking for the cheapest supplier, try to work with local or ethical partners who share your values. Building a long-term relationship with one good supplier is better than switching often for a lower price. This leads to better quality and fewer problems with your orders. When you are honest about where your products come from, your customers will feel better about buying from you.